Cheatsheet — Nmap

Pentesting · Command reference

Quick reference of Nmap scanning commands.

Command	What it does
`nmap -sS <IP>`	Common port scan (TCP). By default it performs an incomplete three-way handshake, only up to the victim's SYN-ACK packet.
`nmap -sV <IP>`	Common port scan (TCP) + service versions.
`nmap -sU <IP>`	Common port scan (UDP).
`nmap -sT <IP>`	Common port scan (TCP) performing the full three-way handshake.
`nmap -sA <IP>`	Common port scan (TCP) sending an ACK packet. Useful to check firewalls.
`nmap -sn <IP>`	Host scan, without port scanning.
`nmap <IP> -p <port>`	Scan of a specific port.
`nmap <IP> -p <p1>-<p2>`	Scan from port 1 to port 2.
`nmap <IP> -p <p1>,<pn>`	Scan of the specified ports separated by commas.
`nmap <IP> -p-`	Scan of all ports.
`nmap <IP> -F`	Scan of the 100 most common ports.
`nmap <IP> --top-ports <n>`	Scan of a specific number of ports (with -F it would be 100).
`nmap <IP> --exclude-ports <ports>`	Scan of the most common ports excluding certain specified ports.
`nmap <IP> -sC`	Scan of the most common ports together with the automatic vulnerability-analysis scripts.
`nmap <IP> --script=<script>`	Scan of the most common ports together with a specific script (located in /usr/share/nmap/scripts).
`nmap <IP> -O`	Scan of the most common ports together with service-version detection and the victim's operating-system detection.
`nmap <IP> -T<1-5>`	Scan of the most common ports with higher or lower speed (5 is fastest, 1 is slowest).
`nmap <IP> -f`	Scan of the most common ports fragmenting the packets to reduce their size and evade firewalls.
`nmap <IP> -A`	Scan of the most common ports + versions + operating system + automated scripts.
`nmap <IP> -oX <name>`	Scan of the most common ports, saving the result in XML format with the given name.
`nmap <IP> -oN <name>`	Scan of the most common ports, saving the result in nmap's normal terminal output format.
`nmap <IP> -v`	Scan of the most common ports with more detailed and clearer output.